

UNIT 1 In Port

It is a lovely autumn day, sunny with a fresh northerly wind. A car arrives at Number 2 berth Gabriel Huidobro Quay at the Raos Dock complex in the Port of Santander. The door of the car opens and a man gets out. Captain Andrew James is back on duty after his annual leave. He says goodbye to the company agent in the car and starts to walk up the gangway to the MS Marina, a multi-purpose dry cargo vessel of 12,000 DWT. She lies moored to the quay at berth No. 3 in the Inner Harbour.

All around him is the life and bustle of the port. Trucks and lorries are rushing back and forth, delivering goods in containers, crates and bales. Stevedores are moving cargo in and out of the warehouses. Crane drivers are operating the quayside cranes and ship's derricks, which are lifting the heavy cargo, loading and unloading the ships. On board the deckhands are attaching slings, hooks and other lifting devices to lift the cargo and store it into the holds and on deck. The deckhands must also lash the cargo so that it will not shift during the voyage.

Important Structures

The Simple Present is used to describe **routines, what happens regularly or is a permanent characteristic**. Listen to the Chief Engineer by clicking on his picture!

Hello, I'm Tom McPhee. I'm a true Scot; I like my whisky, Scottish dancing, and the traditional game of tossing the caber. Today I get my fill of high tech in the computerised control room on the Marina. So during my free time I just want to relax; I enjoy mixing with the crowd in my local pub. I play a lot of golf. We live in a very picturesque small town in the Scottish Highlands.

12 O'CLOCK IN THE PORT OF SANTANDER

Look at the pictures ! What are they doing? The Ing-form / the Progressive Present Tense tells us **what is happening right now!**

Captain James **is working** on the bridge.

The crane driver **is operating** the crane.

The trucks and forklifts **are moving** the cargo out of the warehouses.

The cranes **are lifting** the heavy cargo on board.

The First Mate **is speaking** on the radio.

The Second Mate **is supervising** work on deck.